

Meredith McGee, MPH

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Public health researcher, builder, and writer working at the intersection of housing justice, public health, and civic technology. I design and build tenant-facing data tools grounded in validated public health research, and I write publicly about information and power in the rental market. Founder of RateMyPlace, a health-weighted tenant review platform live in New Haven and Boston. MPH, Yale School of Public Health.

PROJECT

RateMyPlace (ratemyplace.org)

2025 – Present

Founder and Builder

- Designed and built a full-stack web platform solo (Astro, TypeScript, React, Cloudflare); live with a growing base of tenant reviews.
- Built a 27-item housing assessment from three validated public health instruments (OHQS, PHQS, WHO LARES), weighting each item by its documented health impact.
- Engineered privacy-by-design protections (anonymized reviews, season-only date display, no IP or personal-identifier storage) so tenants can report conditions without fear of retaliation.
- Created an ownership-tracing workflow that links each reviewed building to its accountable owner through public records.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Parabola Center for Law and Policy

Malden, MA

Junior Research Fellow

June 2025 – Present

- Co-lead, with Faith English (Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health), an IRB-approved qualitative study on cannabis legalization experiences (Johns Hopkins IRB00034430); conduct interviews and SEM-based deductive coding across 20+ participants.

Parabola Leader

July 2024 – June 2025

- Authored Parabola's foundational essay on the drug policy U-curve; conducted a published interview with Dr. John Marks; moderated public webinars on cannabis policy and equity.

Yale LGBTQ+ Mental Health Initiative (Pachankis Lab)

New Haven, CT

Graduate Research Assistant

Nov 2023 – May 2025

- Coordinated one of the largest psychotherapy studies of sexual minority women (N=450); led recruitment and diagnostic interviews; managed REDCap databases and ran analyses in R across five studies through R01 RCTs.

Yale Center for Interdisciplinary Research on AIDS (CIRA)

New Haven, CT

Health Equity and Social Justice Fellow

2024

- Led a community capacity needs assessment of LGBTQ+ organizations across CT, NY, and NJ; conducted 20+ semi-structured interviews and authored a comprehensive report to inform academic-community partnerships.

Yale Office of Public Health Practice

New Haven, CT

Applied Practice Experience Evaluation Specialist

Nov 2024 – May 2025

- Led full-cycle program evaluation from recruitment and consent through data collection, focus groups, and analysis; delivered actionable recommendations to program leadership.

EDUCATION

Yale School of Public Health

New Haven, CT

Master of Public Health, Social and Behavioral Sciences

May 2025

- Thesis: "Joint Realities: Prevalence, Frequency, and Modality of Cannabis Use by Sexual Identity in a Multi-State BRFSS Sample (2022–2023)." Advised by John Pachankis, PhD.

Lafayette College

Easton, PA

BA, History (Honors); BS, Biology; Minor, Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies

May 2023

PUBLIC WRITING AND MEDIA

Authored

- "Norwood Hospital Was Done In by Inadequate State Regulations. Here Is the Fix." *CommonWealth Beacon*, May 2026.
- "The Corporate Takeover of Cannabis Isn't Inevitable. Here's Proof." *The Parabola Papers*, February 2026.
- "How States Legalize Matters More Than Whether They Do." *The Parabola Papers*, April 2026.
- "The Drug Policy U-Curve" and "Interview with Dr. John Marks." Parabola Center, 2024–2025.
- *Ground Level* (Substack) — Founder and author; essays on housing, drug policy, and health equity.

Featured and quoted

- Quoted as a public health researcher on cannabis potency and consumer markets, *TalkingDrugs*, May 2026.
- Pitched RateMyPlace at the 2026 Yale Innovation Summit; quoted in WTNH / News 8 coverage.

TEACHING

Yale School of Public Health — Teaching Fellow, LGBTQ+ Population Health	Jan – May 2025
Eduexplora — Course Instructor, "Foundations and Frontiers of Genetics"	July 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bradbury-Sullivan LGBT Community Center	Allentown, PA
<i>Grants and Funding Specialist</i>	June 2023 – Present
• Secured over \$1M in foundation, government, and corporate grants for LGBTQ+ health and community programs; independently manage a funding portfolio across forecasting, writing, reporting, and compliance.	
Apothecarium (TerrAscend)	New Jersey
<i>Wellness Associate</i>	2023
• Frontline patient consultation in TerrAscend's highest-grossing NJ dispensary; operational compliance with state tracking and reporting regulations.	

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND HONORS

- University of Illinois Chicago, Cannabis Research Institute — Public Research Series, 2026 (with Douglas Berman, Ohio State).
- American Public Health Association (APHA) Annual Meeting, 2024 — original research on hemp-derived THC marketing under the 2018 Farm Bill.
- Pennsylvania LGBTQIA Health Summit, 2025 — panelist on LGBTQ+ nonprofit funding.
- National Conference on Undergraduate Research, 2023 — oral presentation.
- PATHS STEAM Scholar (2024); Yale SPH Thesis Research Award; Lafayette Pepper Prize Finalist; Mary Armstrong and Mattachine Awards, Lafayette College.

SKILLS

Building and data: Full-stack web development (Astro, TypeScript, React, Cloudflare D1/Pages), Git; public-records research; data structuring and anonymization.

Research methods: Mixed-methods design; qualitative (semi-structured interviews, focus groups, SEM-based deductive coding, thematic analysis); quantitative (survey design, BRFSS secondary analysis, R, REDCap, Qualtrics).

Communication: Grant writing, policy briefs, evaluation reports, and public-facing writing for general audiences.

Certifications: CITI Program (Human Subjects Research; Social and Behavioral Research); Advanced Grant Writing.